Port Brief

Port and shipping conditions for UK importers, forwarders and logistics teams

Issue 1, Sunday 11 October 2026

Two windy spells to plan around at UK and North Sea ports this week

Gusts near crane limits hit Felixstowe and Southampton on Monday and return across the Channel and North Sea from Friday. A deep Atlantic low will hold up ships from North America by 1–2 days. Maersk lifts its UK fuel surcharge to 20%.

The ports this week

Port	Status	What to do	Detail
United Kingdom			
Felixstowe	Watch	Gusts to 16 m/s from 12:00 to 21:00 on Monday may pause cranes. Move Monday afternoon collections to Tuesday morning if you can, and allow 12–24 hours on anything booked tight.	Windy spells: Mon 12:00–21:00, 16 m/s Fri 20:00–21:00, 15 m/s
Southampton	Watch	Two short gusty spells on Monday and Tuesday, then a longer one on Friday from 10:00 to 22:00. Keep Friday bookings flexible and allow 12–24 hours.	Windy spells: Mon 08:00–10:00, 16 m/s Tue 11:00–14:00, 16 m/s Fri 10:00–22:00, 16 m/s and 1 more
London Gateway	Watch	The worst of the week here: gusts to 19 m/s from Friday 16:00 to Saturday 14:00. Tell your haulier now and move Friday evening and Saturday collections to early Friday or Monday.	Windy spells: Fri 16:00–Sat 14:00, 19 m/s Sat 18:00–Sun 01:00, 17 m/s
Liverpool	Running normally	No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. A good week to clear releases: speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.	No crane or pilotage limits forecast.
North Europe			
Rotterdam	Watch	An hour near crane limits on Tuesday evening, then a gustier spell from Saturday 14:00. If you tranship here, confirm weekend feeder connections and allow 12–24 hours.	Windy spells: Tue 17:00–18:00, 15 m/s Sat 14:00–Sun 00:00, 17 m/s
Antwerp	Watch	Brief gusts on Tuesday afternoon, then Friday 13:00 to 20:00 and again from Saturday afternoon. Allow 12–24 hours on Friday and weekend moves.	Windy spells: Tue 16:00–18:00, 15 m/s Fri 13:00–20:00, 16 m/s Sat 15:00–Sun 01:00, 17 m/s
Bremerhaven	Watch	Gusty again on Tuesday from 09:00 to 13:00 and late on Saturday. Allow 12–24 hours on Tuesday vessel calls and avoid tight cut-offs.	Windy spells: Sun 09:00–12:00, 18 m/s Tue 09:00–13:00, 15 m/s Sat 20:00–Sun 01:00, 16 m/s
Hamburg	Watch	Gusts near crane limits on Tuesday from 08:00 to 15:00 and late on Saturday. Allow 12–24 hours on Tuesday and keep weekend plans flexible.	Windy spells: Sun 09:00–12:00, 18 m/s Tue 08:00–15:00, 16 m/s Tue 21:00–22:00, 15 m/s and 1 more

Congestion figures were not available for this issue, so each status reflects weather forecasts and port news only. Weather times are UK local time. Buffers follow the Port Brief playbook and assume normal carrier free time.

Weather on the routes into Europe

A deep low in the mid-North Atlantic brings seas of 6 m and gusts near 30 m/s on Tuesday and Wednesday. Ships from North America crossing in that window are likely to arrive 1–2 days late. Don't book haulage against the published ETA; confirm the revised ETA with your carrier before you commit.



Circled: sea areas where the forecast for the next six days is rough enough to slow ships heading for Europe (amber: possible delay; red: delay likely). The box shows the area of the ports map.

North European ports



Ports coloured by this week's status: running normally, watch, congested, disruption likely.

Expected delays on the way in

Sea area	When	Delay
Mid-North Atlantic Transatlantic services from North America	Mon 12 Oct to Thu 15 Oct	1–2 days

Six-day forecast at the ports

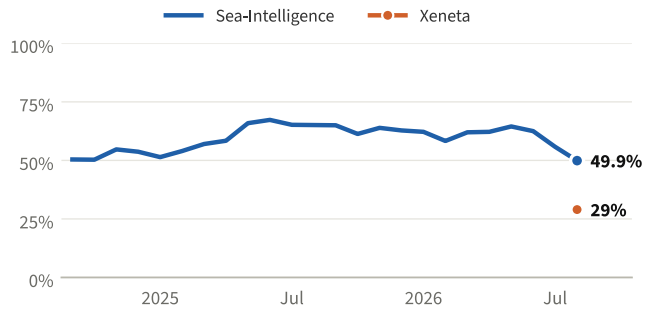
Peak gusts (m/s) and sea (m)	Sun 11	Mon 12	Tue 13	Wed 14	Thu 15	Fri 16	Sat 17
Felixstowe	9 / 0.5	**16 / 1.0**	13 / 0.8	7 / 0.5	11 / 0.7	**15 / 0.6**	14 / 1.1
Southampton	12 / 0.5	**16 / 1.4**	**16 / 1.5**	9 / 0.6	10 / 0.8	**16 / 0.7**	**15 / 0.8**
London Gateway	9 / 0.5	14 / 0.6	12 / 0.6	8 / 0.3	7 / 0.5	**19 / 1.0**	**18 / 1.6**
Liverpool	13 / 0.9	15 / 0.7	14 / 1.3	13 / 1.0	13 / 1.0	14 / 1.0	12 / 0.9
Rotterdam	15 / 1.8	14 / 0.9	**15 / 1.2**	10 / 0.9	11 / 0.6	15 / 1.4	**17 / 1.7**
Antwerp	15 / 1.6	14 / 0.8	**15 / 1.2**	9 / 0.8	9 / 0.5	**16 / 1.7**	**17 / 1.9**
Bremerhaven	**18 / 1.4**	9 / 0.9	**15 / 1.1**	14 / 1.4	11 / 0.8	13 / 1.5	**16 / 2.1**
Hamburg	**18 / 1.7**	9 / 1.1	**16 / 1.4**	14 / 1.7	12 / 1.0	13 / 1.6	**16 / 2.4**

Shaded amber where gusts reach 15 m/s or seas reach 2.5 m, when crane work or pilot boarding may pause; red from 20 m/s or 3.5 m, when it usually stops. Days run midnight to midnight UTC.

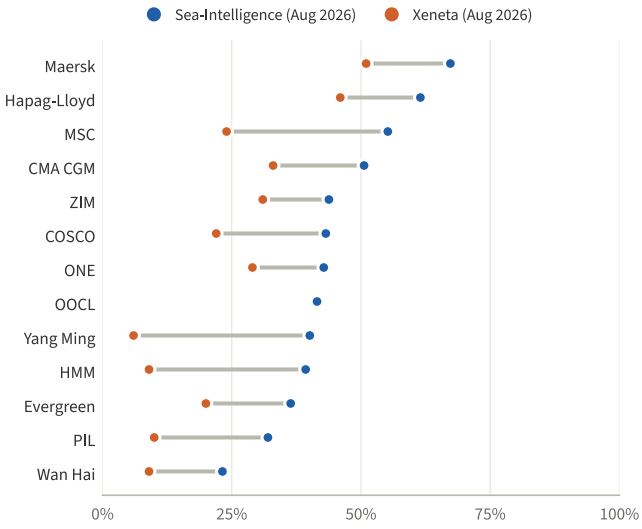
Schedule reliability

Sea-Intelligence puts August global schedule reliability at 49.9%, down 5.9 points on July and 15.2 points on a year earlier. Late ships arrived 6.81 days behind schedule on average. Xeneta measures 29% for the same month. The 20.9-point gap comes from method: Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time within one day of schedule, Xeneta only on the scheduled day. Both rank Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd first and second. For planning, assume about half of arrivals will miss their scheduled day and keep delivery promises loose.

Share of ships arriving on time, worldwide



The same carriers, measured two ways, Aug 2026



Carrier	Sea-Intelligence, Aug 2026	Xeneta, Aug 2026	Difference, points
Maersk	67.3%	51%	+16
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	46%	+16
MSC	55.2%	24%	+31
CMA CGM	50.6%	33%	+18
ZIM	43.8%	31%	+13
COSCO	43.2%	22%	+21
ONE	42.8%	29%	+14
OOCL	41.5%	Not ranked	
Yang Ming	40.1%	6%	+34
HMM	39.3%	9%	+30
Evergreen	36.4%	20%	+16
PIL	32.0%	10%	+22
Wan Hai	23.2%	9%	+14

Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time if it is within one day of schedule (34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers). Late ships arrived 6.81 days behind schedule on average.

Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Notices from ports and carriers

Maersk has raised its fuel surcharge for the UK and Ireland to 20% and has raised its S5S contingency surcharge. MSC has restored a direct service from Karachi to seven European ports. Hapag-Lloyd has suspended bookings to the Philippines because of port congestion there and announced a North America GRI. CMA CGM adds a reefer surcharge from Northern Europe to Latin America.

Maersk

Maersk raises S5S contingency surcharge
Container News, Sat 10 Oct. New since the last issue

Maersk raises fuel surcharge to 20% in UK and Ireland
FreshPlaza, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC

MSC Restores Direct Karachi Service to Seven European Ports
Retail News Asia, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd

ICT: Hapag-Lloyd suspends Philippine bookings amid port congestion
Philstar.com, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd announces North America GRI
Container News, Mon 5 Oct. New since the last issue

CMA CGM

CMA CGM sets €100 reefer surcharge from Northern Europe to Latin America
DatamarNews, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

CMA CGM revamps Asia–East Coast South America services from December
DatamarNews, Thu 8 Oct. New since the last issue

How to read this brief. Weather flags are forecasts, not port notices: they mark the hours when wind or sea is likely to reach the levels at which terminals usually pause crane work or pilots stop boarding. Always confirm with your terminal or carrier before changing plans.

Sources. Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Maps use Natural Earth data.

Data this issue. weather: complete; tropical storms: complete; congestion: not connected; schedule reliability: complete; notices: complete.